



TWELVE-MONTH PROGRESS REPORT

Public debate and participation in policymaking: progress report, 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-17

Edition of 2026-08-18 · compiled from the Data Landscapers source base

24 places. Every table below is carried verbatim from that place's own progress report; nothing is written here.

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Benin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Internet freedom ranking	BASELINE NOT HELD	4th in Africa on a 2026 internet-freedom assessment	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Burkina Faso

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Broadcasting regulator	A standalone regulator of public communication exercising new social-media powers over users with 5,000 or more followers	Its regulation of public communication passes to the merged authority, putting broadcast-content regulation and data-protection supervision under one college	CLOSED, SUBJECT TO PROMULGATION
Organic law on social-media regulation	Extends regulatory powers to social-media users with at least 5,000 followers, with operationalisation started in 2024	Same; no held source records any change, and the enforcing body is folded into the merged authority	NO CHANGE

Burundi

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Etats generaux de la communication	Did not exist	Proposed; no response from government or operators on file	ADVANCED

Cameroon

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Election-period network restrictions	No restriction recorded in the base for the year to 2025-08	Four shutdowns recorded in Cameroon in 2025, including election-period restrictions on social platforms	REGRESSED

Central African Republic

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Regulator request for tighter identification and platform account closures	Did not exist	Requests for better control of subscriber identification to limit anonymous accounts, activation of international judicial cooperation against content produced abroad, and cooperation with international platforms on reporting and closing accounts; no instrument adopted	ADVANCED

Chad

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Suspension of applications to create online newspapers	Not held - the base carries no record of the media regulator before 2026-08-03	Examination suspended indefinitely, with no published criteria, no end date and no transitional treatment of applications already filed, so existing licensed online outlets are a closed list for the duration	REGRESSED, BASELINE NOT HELD
Internet shutdown in Lac province	Offline since 2024-10-28, with no restoration recorded	No restoration, extension or official justification on record, and the base carries nothing on it inside the window	NO CHANGE
Media regulator's three-year strategic plan for 2026-2028	Not held	In application, with the plan itself, its axes in full and its publication date not held	BASELINE NOT HELD

Comoros

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Code de l'information et de la communication, as amended	The 2021 statute in force unamended, at 292 articles	Amended - twenty-five articles amended and eighteen deleted, with the government's proposed exception to source protection struck on the floor, so source protection is now unqualified	ADVANCED

Cote d'Ivoire

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Consumer grievance platform	Did not exist	Live application and web platform at FCFA 150 per report, with eight stages from filing through mediation to published reports and sectoral dashboards	ADVANCED

DR Congo

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Permanent state-industry consultation framework for the digital sector	Did not exist	Agreed as a standing mechanism between the ministry and the Réseau des acteurs du numérique after the dispute over the digital-sector tariff; no constituting text, membership or meeting schedule stated	ADVANCED

Egypt

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Council of State digital transformation plan	The base carries no record that the administrative-justice branch had a digitisation programme	The head of the Council of State told a meeting of administrative-court circuit presidents that the Council continues to implement an integrated digital transformation plan, developing its information infrastructure and adopting current technology to speed litigation; no named system, date, figure or deliverable is stated	BASELINE NOT HELD
VAT credit-refund period reduction	The base carries no earlier statement of the refund period or of the proposal	A proposed cut of the credit-refund period to four months for taxpayers and three for small and medium enterprises is still awaiting its legislative steps; a tax association board member added that the reduction will not meet its objects unless the operational problems obstructing proof of balances are resolved first	BASELINE NOT HELD

Eswatini

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Public account of the Google memorandum	Not on the record	Established after a public contradiction between the prime minister and the Attorney-General	ADVANCED

Gabon

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Haute Autorite de la Communication decision n 0002/HAC/2026 suspending social media	No social-media suspension on the record	In force about five months; the Presidency calls it temporary and conservatory, and nine civil-society organisations call it unconstitutional and beyond the authority's remit and demand abrogation	REGRESSED

Liberia

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Anti-Corruption Commission complaint against the LTA	Did not exist	Under investigation, with no evidence publicly produced and no findings made (2026-07)	ADVANCED

Mali

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Speech prosecutions before the cybercrime pole	None on file	Chahana Takiou, publication director of 22 septembre, sentenced to 12 months with six suspended	REGRESSED

Mauritius

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Public argument on what digital investment is for	BASELINE NOT HELD	The clearest domestic objection on file to the artificial-intelligence-first framing: that contract enforcement rather than technology is the binding constraint, with digitalised case management prescribed alongside a small-claims process and a stronger commercial division rather than instead of them (2026-08)	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Namibia

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Published draft and consultation record of the Data Protection Bill	Did not exist	A dated consultation record: the ministry opened public input on the draft Data Protection Bill on 2022-10-26 with a closing date of 2022-11-30, addressed to two named ministry officers; the ACTION Namibia Coalition filed a submission on the closing date, compiled by ALT Advisory and funded by the Embassy of Finland through IPPR's Democracy Report project; IPPR published the same argument as a public paper on 2022-12-14, arguing the sections on the Supervisory Authority's independence need substantial redrafting and that offences and penalties provisions are undeveloped; no ministry-published list of respondents is held, and no further consultation activity is on record since	ADVANCED

Niger

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
PNDN 2026-2035 consultation and validation process	Did not exist	A redrafting committee installed 2025-07-18 revised the draft policy; a national validation workshop held 2026-03-11 was described by the ministry as the product of broad consultation among public- and private-sector digital-ecosystem actors; no separate open public-comment or civil-society submission channel is named	ADVANCED

Rwanda

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Internet governance forum	BASELINE NOT HELD	An annual multistakeholder forum run under the domain registry, with nearly 200 people through a school on internet governance and a youth forum	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Sao Tome and Principe

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
FGI STP (Forum de Governanca da Internet)	Did not exist	1st edition held, regulator (AGER)-convened; agenda covered digital trust, infrastructure, regulation, privacy/data protection, AI, internet/social media; no outcome document or next-edition date published	ADVANCED

Senegal

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Social-media regulation workstream	BASELINE NOT HELD	Under way since 2024; no bill, decree or timetable named, and an observatory is a proposal	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Uganda

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Fourth-cycle Universal Periodic Review	Third-cycle review concluded January 2022 with 273 recommendations, 139 supported and 134 noted; no fourth-cycle submission on file (2025-08)	Joint submission by CIPESA, APC and WOUGNET filed, seeking repeal of the Computer Misuse Act speech offences, a statutory bar on network disruption, removal of the 12% excise duty on internet data, and statutory independence and fining powers for the Personal Data Protection Office; the review had not been held as at 2026-08-07	ADVANCED
Judiciary media guidelines issued through ECCMIS	Did not exist (2025-08)	Prior accreditation required, devices barred from the courtroom, live broadcasting granted case by case; the Law Society asked for the restrictions to be lifted	ADVANCED
URA e-Tax2 award	Technical evaluation notice displayed 2025-08-25, under challenge	Award set aside by the Appeals Tribunal on a power-of-attorney defect, the capacity objection struck out unadjudicated; none of 26 commercial banks would issue the guarantee gating the 15% advance; joint-venture staff on the revenue authority's premises since January with no work started	STALLED

Zambia

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Public consultation on the Postal Services Act review	Baseline not held	The ministry invited any member of the public to submit proposals for amendment with justification, closing 2026-07-27, a window of three days from the call reported on 2026-07-24; no submission count, published responses or consultation report is held	CLOSED
Human Rights Commission election-period cases	Baseline not held	The Commission's chairperson said its case review meeting considered 105 alleged human rights violations and abuses linked to the election period, of which 62 were resolved through mediation, engagement with responsible institutions, referral for legal assistance, corrective measures and other redress; duty-bearers implicated included law enforcement agencies and justice-sector institutions	BASELINE NOT HELD
ZICTA consent judgment on internet access interruption	No position held on internet-shutdown constraints in Zambia at 2025-08-01	In force on the coalition's account: the regulator undertook not to act outside its authority to interrupt access and to state the reason for any future interruption within 36 hours, after civil society challenged the August 2021 blocking of four platforms; the technology ministry has committed not to shut down the internet at the 13 August 2026 election, and the government has said it could not establish the cause of the 2021 shutdown. No judgment date, cause number or enforcement instance is held	BASELINE NOT HELD

Zimbabwe

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Public consultation record for the National AI Strategy	None published	The strategy's own consultation record — a Kadoma draft, then validation at Harare on 2025-08-28, Bulawayo on 2025-09-09 and Masvingo on 2025-09-11; no submission register, participant list or consultation report is held	ADVANCED

West Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Regional Feminist Data Agenda 2026-2028	Did not exist	Ratified with three priorities for 2026-2028, each carrying a named owner, alongside eight thematic policy briefs and a cross-border encrypted data collective with rapid-response protocols; no text is published	ADVANCED

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.